For a larger application, though, it’s not so easy. All the CoffeeScript files need to be compiled. The compiled files might need to go into a specific directory, and some other files may need to go in there with them. For a large application, the build can be complicated. Instead of doing it manually each time, the build itself should be a CoffeeScript program. Otherwise, there’s a good chance you’ll end up creating complicated software with a complicated build process that nobody can understand—similar to what Scruffy experiences in figure 12.3.

Figure 12.3. A build that nobody understands often results in disaster.



Keep your build simple. A simple build written in CoffeeScript can be made with something called *Cake*. In this section you’ll learn about Cake and how to use it to create tasks for your build and for your tests. You’ll also learn about task dependencies.

12.2.1. Cake and build tasks